

They needed new game titles too. Sony started garnering support of major game developers at the time and by the time of its US launch it already had secured more than 100 licenses in USA and about 250 licenses in Japan alone. It also realised the importance of an in house game development team and hence purchased Psygnosis, a European game development house and rebranded it as Sony Interactive Entertainment. Though a controversial acquisition at the time, the decision proved to be successful with the publishing house going ahead to make some of the best PlayStation games that the gamer community has seen till date.

The PlayStation was a huge success and slowly settled into the top spot amongst its generation.

Nintendo 64

Named after its 64 bit processor, Nintendo 64 was the last successful console to use the older cartridge based system and the last 5th generation console to be launched too. Launched in 1996, the device went through a development hell with plans of launching it with an optical disk drive getting cancelled twice and Nintendo finally launching it without it.

The console was a critical success and went on to sell more than 32 million devices. Slated for an initial Christmas 1995 launch, N 64's release got delayed. Fearing losing its customers to other consoles over the holiday season, Nintendo aggressively marketed the console and hyped the launch with advertisements asking you "Is it worth the wait? Only if you want the best"

The games launched on the platform were still limited by the cartridge based system and only had a maximum of 64 MB to show their prowess. The console featured one of the most powerful GPUs of its generation capable of many advanced rendering feats including something called 'trilinear filtering' which made the textures look smoother compared to the Saturn and PlayStation. The cartridge based system carried one primary advantage though – it had faster load times than its optical drive carrying counterparts



Developed by Sony's inhouse game development team, Gran Turismo went on to become one of the highest selling game of the platform spanning more than 7 games.